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From left: Steven Ortiz, Jason DaRosa, and Tommy Ortiz.

Report of misdeeds ends big drug case

DA says officer's involvement 'tainted' charges

By Dugan Arnett and Andrew Ryan

GLOBE STAFF

FALL RIVER — In a dramatic reversal, Bristol County prosecutors abruptly dismissed a long-running case Friday against an alleged drug trafficker and three co-defendants after defense lawyers accused New Bedford police of dishonesty and misconduct with a confidential informant at the center of the case.

The accused trafficker, Steven Ortiz, was arrested nearly eight years ago after a lengthy investigation by a multi-agency task force.

The messy legal saga, which culminated in a heated hearing Friday morning, has brought added attention to New Bedford's embattled police department and raised broader questions about law enforcement's use of informants.

The misconduct cited in the dismissal was first exposed in a 2023 Globe Magazine story, which revealed the detective at the center of the probe, Jared Lucas, had a yearslong sexual relationship with the confidential informant linked to the matter, a woman named Carly Medeiros.

While she was secretly seeing Lucas, Medeiros alleges, the detective was using information gleaned from her — without her knowledge — to build a drug

SPOTLIGHT, Page A10

The Trump administration continued to pursue its fight against securing the freedom of a Maryland man it inadvertently deported to a Salvadoran prison despite a court order that expressly said he could remain in the United States. **A2.**

European countries vowed to send billions of dollars to help Ukraine keep fighting Russia's invasion. **A4.**

Boston University takes on Western Michigan tonight in the NCAA men's hockey championship. The teams don't meet often, but the coaches say they're ready. **C1.**



Water slips down

Saturday: Wintry mix. High: 37-42. Low: 34-39.
Sunday: Chilly, drizzle. High: 44-49. Low: 39-44.
Sunrise: 6:08 Sunset: 7:22
Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**
Obituaries, **C9.**

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China volleys back in tariff battle

Beijing raises rate on US goods to 125%; Trump advisers urge calm and optimism

By Alexandra Stevenson

NEW YORK TIMES

HONG KONG — China on Friday said it was raising its tariffs on American goods to 125 percent, retaliating for the third time in the escalating trade war between the two superpowers.

The brinkmanship between President Trump and Xi Jinping, China's

top leader, threatens to rip apart trade ties between the world's two largest economies after years of simmering tensions.

China accompanied its announcement of the higher levies, which take effect Saturday, with a mocking statement calling Trump's tariff policies "a joke."

The announcement by the State

Council, China's Cabinet, followed a clarification Thursday by the Trump administration that Chinese goods imported to the United States now face a minimum tariff rate of 145 percent.

Over the past two weeks, China and the United States have been engaged in a fast-moving tit-for-tat that has resulted in ever-higher barriers to trade, churning markets and threatening economies around the world.

US stocks ended the week on a

positive note, with the S&P 500 rising about 2 percent, although it remained 5 percent below its value April 2, the day Trump announced a raft of global tariffs. Yields on US government bonds rose again Friday, in a sign that the world's faith in the US economy had been shaken by Trump's trade war with China.

Laurence D. Fink, CEO of giant asset manager BlackRock, said Friday morning on CNBC that the United States had become "the global de-

TARIFFS, Page A6

'Anything new that comes in will have that price increase.'

MATT DIEKMANN, owner of The Wine Bottega in the North End



PHOTOS BY DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Chef Jianjun Peng made a dish before the dinner rush at District Kitchen in Malden. Stacey Zhang, the restaurant's owner, is optimistic about the president's tariff strategy.

RISING COSTS WITH A SIDE OF WORRY

Restaurant owners say they'll find ways to work with added levies

By Esmey Jimenez

GLOBE STAFF

and Nathan Metcalf

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Efrain Sanchez wheeled a dolly carrying Maseca corn flour and beer into Lynn's Casa Antigua restaurant on a recent Friday afternoon. The restaurant, which serves Central American and Mexican food, was nearly empty, save for a man at the bar asking for a beer, and a mother and her child eating a late lunch.

This is the state of Casa Antigua these days: The restaurant, which opened in 2010 and is still trying to overcome the setbacks of the pandemic, faces a political climate that threatens deportation to some of its customer base and local community, and an economy that feels unstable due partly to inflation.

Now, there is even more uncertainty. President Trump on Wednesday afternoon announced that he paused his hiked-up tariffs on most countries for 90 days, just hours after the tariffs went into effect. China, though, would see an even steeper import tax, up to 125 percent "effective

RESTAURANTS, Page A6



Spices such as star anise and tsaoko are imported and used in many dishes at District Kitchen, where unique cocktails and traditional recipes are part of the draw.

Sounding out the legacy of William Dawes

Is a poem all that kept him from the fame of fellow rider Paul Revere?

By Billy Baker

GLOBE STAFF

*Listen my children, and give your applause,
For the midnight ride of William Dawes.*

Meh. Doesn't have the same ring to it. It's tricky to rhyme anything with Dawes. Gauze. Claws. Straws. Flaws.

But rhyming Revere is so clear, my dear.

As we approach the 250th anniversary of the "midnight ride" that kicked off the American Revolution, the legacy of Dawes, the *other* rider who set out from Boston on that fateful night of April 18, 1775, to warn Lexington that the Redcoats were coming, is receiving renewed focus.

And with it, comes an old question: Is this all about a poem? If Henry Wadsworth Longfellow had not focused on Revere in his famous 1861 ode to the midnight ride, would both men stand on equal footing in American history?

There is no question that their legacies are unequal. Revere, a patriot leader and famous silversmith, has statues and a city named after him. Dawes is believed to be buried in an unmarked grave in Forest Hills Cemetery.

DAWES, Page A10



ALLY RZESA/GLOBE STAFF

The pull of McKinley and Polk

2 presidents who resonate with Trump

By Jim Puzzanghera

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — President Trump wants to take America back to what he considers the good old days: the 1800s.

He has an unusual fascination with two obscure 19th-century presidents — James K. Polk and William McKinley. Both championed what many consider outdated policies that Trump is now trying to revive, including levying massive tariffs on imports and acquiring territory around the world.

Polk's portrait now hangs in the Oval Office alongside those of icons such as George Washington, Thomas Jefferson, and Ronald Reagan. And Trump sent Americans scrambling to Google in January when he gave McKinley a high-profile shout-out in his second inaugural address.

"We will restore the name of a great president, William McKinley, to Mount McKinley, where it should be and where it belongs," Trump said of North America's highest peak, in Alaska, which President Barack Obama had renamed Denali. "President McKinley made our country very rich through tariffs and through talent."

Trump has reached back to the pair of presidents as avatars of his push to return the United States to a bygone era, historians said. Those were the days when tariff revenue fully funded the federal government (he has unrealistically suggested that might be possible again) and the United States gobbled up vast swaths of land in North America and beyond (Trump has mused about acquiring Canada, Greenland, and the Panama Canal).

"We were building, with Bill Clinton and Al Gore, the bridge to the 21st century," said Barbara A. Perry, profes-

McKINLEY, Page A7